Growing Together

Montessori curriculum planning and record keeping | Ages 3-6 | Printable working packet

Use this packet alongside Montessori_Planning_and_Records.html, or print blank copies for a paper-based workflow. The library contains 72 introductory planning outlines. They support trained staff; they are not a complete Montessori training album or an endorsed certification course.

The working cycle

1. Observe: notice interests, movement, language and the support actually needed.

2. Plan: choose a few purposeful invitations linked to evidence. Keep familiar work available.

3. Present: invite, demonstrate clearly, allow a choice, and show restoration.

4. Step back: protect concentration and allow repetition; intervene for safety and meaningful support.

5. Record: write dated facts and a possible next opportunity. Revisit across time and contexts.

Six connected areas

Practical life: Independence, coordinated movement, care of self and others.

Sensorial: Careful comparison, sensory language, order and discrimination.

Language: Conversation, sound awareness, writing, reading and meaning.

Mathematics: Quantity, symbols, place value, operations and mathematical language.

Cultural studies: Geography, living things, community, scientific inquiry and respect.

Art, music & movement: Creative choices, rhythm, expression, movement and collaboration.

Privacy and storage

The browser tool saves locally on the device, without accounts or automatic cloud backup. Export a full JSON backup regularly. Keep names and notes private. This system does not replace attendance, incident, medication, safeguarding or formal special-education records.

Print to A4 or US Letter using “Fit to printable area.” Blank tracker dates are not age expectations or evidence of a learning gap.

Sequence without deadlines

A mixed-age room offers different levels of work at the same time.

Exploring

Belonging, practical routines, coordinated movement, sensory comparison, oral language and concrete quantities. Offer accessible meaningful work and watch for readiness.

Developing

Longer sequences, finer comparisons, sound-symbol relationships, composing words, quantity-symbol connections and sustained inquiry. Keep earlier work available for repetition.

Extending

Reading for meaning, purposeful writing, concrete decimal operations, research, collaboration and creative projects. Greater complexity follows observable understanding, not a birthday.

Observation labels

Interest observed: A child noticed or chose related work; this does not establish performance.

Presented: A lesson was demonstrated; further presentations may be useful.

Practicing: A child is working with the material. Record errors and the support used.

Independent in observation: The child worked without the recorded adult support in this event. Keep observing across days and contexts.

Revisit / offer support: Another invitation, a different material or additional support may help. Avoid labels about the child.

Weekly review questions

What did the child return to? What support helped? Which current plan is no longer useful? Where do we lack observations? Which materials need repair or adaptation? What family perspective would help?

Do not turn coverage into a quota. “Not recorded” is a statement about the record, not the child’s ability. Include home languages and accessible communication, movement and materials.

Child profile

Teaching information only. Use an identifier if a full name is unnecessary.

Child / identifier and date of birth

Enrollment date and guide / key teacher

Home languages and preferred communication

Strengths and sources of confidence

Current interests and repeated choices

Useful access and teaching supports

Family perspective and date of conversation

Keep medical, safeguarding and formal support documents in the program’s approved systems. Review the profile when interests or supports change.

Weekly invitations

Week of: _____ Guide / group: _____

Plan a small number of purposeful invitations. Maintain complete familiar work, a protected work cycle, outdoor access and room for the child’s own choices.

Day / date	Child or small group	Invitation / evidence for readiness	Prepare / adapt	Outcome / follow-up
Monday				
Tuesday				
Wednesday				
Thursday				
Friday				

Child-chosen work and emerging interests to revisit

Environment preparation / repairs / family follow-up

Individual lesson plan

Child / small group: _____ Date / guide: _____

Area, lesson and direct aim

Observed readiness / relevant earlier work

Materials, preparation and access supports

Presentation sequence and restoration

Point of interest and feedback / control of error

Safety considerations and what to observe

Possible next invitation, depending on the outcome

Dated observation

Child / identifier: _____ Date / recorder: _____

Lesson / work and context of the invitation

What was actually seen or heard? Include a brief quote if useful.

Support actually given / how the child responded

Engagement and self-chosen repetition

Status in this observation - circle one

Interest observed | Presented | Practicing | Independent in observation | Revisit / offer support

Possible next invitation and when to revisit

Example: “Poured twice. On the second attempt, stopped before the cup filled and wiped one spill without a reminder.” Avoid “Mastered water work.” A declined invitation is not a failure.

Practical life record

Child / identifier: _____ Review date: _____

Enter dates, not permanent mastery checks. Record the actual support and a next invitation. One independent performance is one observation, not an age-based completion requirement.

Library lesson	Presented date	Practice dates	Independent observation date	Support / next step
L001 Carrying a tray				
L002 Rolling and unrolling a work rug				
L003 Dry pouring				
L004 Pouring water				
L005 Transferring with a spoon				
L006 Using tongs				
L007 Handwashing sequence				
L008 Buttoning frame				
L009 Zipping frame				
L010 Washing a table				
L011 Sweeping a small spill				
L012 Preparing a simple snack				
L013 Inviting someone and respecting “no”				
L014 Resolving a disagreement				

Custom lessons / child-led inquiry: _____

Record coverage is not an attainment score. Use a separate dated observation for evidence, context and the child’s response.

Sensorial record

Child / identifier: _____ Review date: _____

Enter dates, not permanent mastery checks. Record the actual support and a next invitation. One independent performance is one observation, not an age-based completion requirement.

Library lesson	Presented date	Practice dates	Independent observation date	Support / next step
L015 Pink tower				
L016 Brown stair				
L017 Red rods				
L018 Cylinder blocks				
L019 Color matching				
L020 Color grading				
L021 Geometric cabinet: matching shapes				
L022 Touch tablets				
L023 Sound cylinders				
L024 Geometric solids				

Custom lessons / child-led inquiry: _____

Record coverage is not an attainment score. Use a separate dated observation for evidence, context and the child’s response.

Language record

Child / identifier: _____ Review date: _____

Enter dates, not permanent mastery checks. Record the actual support and a next invitation. One independent performance is one observation, not an age-based completion requirement.

Library lesson	Presented date	Practice dates	Independent observation date	Support / next step
L025 Conversation and precise naming				
L026 Three-period vocabulary lesson				
L027 Sound game: beginning sounds				
L028 Sound game: segmenting words				
L029 Sandpaper letters				
L030 Metal insets				
L031 Movable alphabet: encoding words				
L032 Phonetic word reading				
L033 Phonograms and common spelling patterns				
L034 Puzzle words / high-frequency words				
L035 Reading action commands				
L036 Noun and article exploration				
L037 Sentence reading and comprehension				
L038 Storytelling and making a book				

Custom lessons / child-led inquiry: _____

Record coverage is not an attainment score. Use a separate dated observation for evidence, context and the child’s response.

Mathematics record

Child / identifier: _____ Review date: _____

Enter dates, not permanent mastery checks. Record the actual support and a next invitation. One independent performance is one observation, not an age-based completion requirement.

Library lesson	Presented date	Practice dates	Independent observation date	Support / next step
L039 Number rods				
L040 Sandpaper numerals				
L041 Number rods and numerals				
L042 Spindle boxes and zero				
L043 Cards and counters: odd and even				
L044 Golden beads: decimal quantities				
L045 Decimal symbols and composition				
L046 Golden bead static addition				
L047 Golden bead exchange and dynamic addition				
L048 Golden bead subtraction				
L049 Golden bead multiplication				
L050 Golden bead sharing / division				
L051 Teen quantities and symbols				
L052 Tens quantities and symbols				
L053 Bead chains and skip counting				
L054 Fraction insets: whole and equal parts				

Custom lessons / child-led inquiry: _____

Record coverage is not an attainment score. Use a separate dated observation for evidence, context and the child’s response.

Cultural studies record

Child / identifier: _____ Review date: _____

Enter dates, not permanent mastery checks. Record the actual support and a next invitation. One independent performance is one observation, not an age-based completion requirement.

Library lesson	Presented date	Practice dates	Independent observation date	Support / next step
L055 Land, water and globe exploration				
L056 Continents: shapes and names				
L057 Landforms: island and lake				
L058 Living and nonliving inquiry				
L059 Parts and care of a plant				
L060 Seed germination observation				
L061 Animal classification and needs				
L062 Magnetic and nonmagnetic materials				
L063 Weather journal				
L064 Personal timeline and change				
L065 Community helpers and real roles				
L066 Cultural inquiry with families				

Custom lessons / child-led inquiry: _____

Record coverage is not an attainment score. Use a separate dated observation for evidence, context and the child’s response.

Art, music & movement record

Child / identifier: _____ Review date: _____

Enter dates, not permanent mastery checks. Record the actual support and a next invitation. One independent performance is one observation, not an age-based completion requirement.

Library lesson	Presented date	Practice dates	Independent observation date	Support / next step
L067 Open-ended drawing				
L068 Cutting and collage				
L069 Clay and modeling				
L070 Rhythm echo and choice				
L071 Pitch comparison and singing				
L072 Walking the line and expressive movement				

Custom lessons / child-led inquiry: _____

Record coverage is not an attainment score. Use a separate dated observation for evidence, context and the child’s response.